

Levin S. Güver

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Employment

CURRENT

- 2026– **Postdoctoral Researcher & Inaugural ‘Normz’ Teaching Fellow**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich
— Zurich Program on Law and Normative Reflection (‘Normz’)
- 2023– **Research Associate**
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Graz
— Chair of Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

PREVIOUS

- 2023–2025 **Graduate Lecturer**
Faculty of Law, University College London
- 2019–2023 **Research Assistant**
Faculty of Law & Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich
— Chair of Applied Ethics (2019–23)
— Chair of Criminal Law, Criminal Procedure Law, and Criminology (2022)
— Chair of Philosophy and Theory of Law, Legal Soc., and Int. Publ. Law (2020–22)
— ‘Fundamental Psychological Dispositions in Human-Robot Interactions’ (2020)

Education

DEGREES

- 2022–2026 **Ph.D. in Law**
Faculty of Law & Dpt. of Philosophy, University College London
Supervised by Mark Dsouza and John Hyman
Examined by Antony Duff and Leo Zaibert (*pass with no corrections*)
- 2019–2021 **Master of Law**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich
summa cum laude, Valedictorian (rank 1/215)
- 2015–2019 **Bachelor of Law**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich

RESEARCH STAYS

- 2025 **Yale Law School**
Invited by Gideon Yaffe and Joshua Knobe (Feb–May 2025)
- 2023, 2025 **Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law**
Invited by Philipp-Alexander Hirsch (Jun–Sep 2023) and Sabine Gless (Jun–Aug 2025)

Publications

ARTICLES

- 2025 **‘Causation, Norms, and Cognitive Bias’** (with M. Kneer). *Cognition*, 259, 106105.
- 2025 **‘Untangling the Gordian Knot of Motive’**. *Journal of Legal Philosophy*, 50(1), pp. 1–26.
 — winner of ASLP Essay Prize
 — runner-up for Young Scholar Prize
- 2024 **‘The Unity of Motive’**. *Argumenta*, 9(2), pp. 231–245.
 — winner of Lex Academic Prize
 — runner-up for NEN Paper Prize

BOOK CHAPTERS

- 2026 **‘Understanding the Mentalist Theory of Law and Morality’**. In S. Summers & A. Sajo (eds.), *Human Rights Restated: An Investigation of Mind and Rights* (pp. tbd). Cambridge University Press.
- 2023 **‘Causation and the Silly Norm Effect’** (with M. Kneer). In S. Magen & K. Prochownik (eds.), *Advances in Experimental Philosophy of Law* (pp. 133–168). Bloomsbury Press.
 — runner-up for William James Prize

PEER-REVIEWED PROCEEDINGS

- 2023 **‘Causation, Foreseeability, and Norms’** (with M. Kneer). *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*, 45, pp. 888–895.

OTHER

- 2024 **‘Criminalisation and Its Limits’**. *Criminal Justice Theory Blog*, online Nov 15th.
- 2023 **‘Motive and Criminal Liability’**. *Criminal Justice Theory Blog*, online Aug 4th.
- 2019 **‘From Is to Ought: How Scientific Research in the Field of Moral Cognition Can Impact the Criminal Law’**. *Cognitio: Student Law Forum*, 1(2), pp. 1–22.

Teaching

† = undergraduate [8], ‡ = graduate [3]

CO-INSTRUCTOR

- Fall ‘26 **Legal Philosophy** †
 Faculty of Law, University of Zurich
- Spring ‘26 **Crime, Punishment, and Equality** ‡
 Faculty of Law, University of Zurich
- Winter ‘25 **Wrongs and Crimes: Rethinking Consent, Coercion, and State Power** ‡
 Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Erlangen-Nuremberg

Fall '21 **Theory and Philosophy of Law †**
Faculty of Law, University of Zurich

GRADUATE LECTURER

Terms 1–2 '23, '24 **Criminal Law †**
Faculty of Law, University College London

Term 1 '23, '24 **Introduction to Law †**
Faculty of Law, University College London
— Case Study on *Medical Accidents* (Term 1 '24)
— Case Study on *Fake News and Falsehoods* (Term 1 '23)

TUTOR

Fall '21 **Blame and Punishment †**
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich

Fall '20 **Theories of Morality ‡**
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich

Spring '20 ***The View from Nowhere: Objectivity and Subjectivity in Practical Philosophy* †**
Dpt. of Philosophy, University of Zurich

Awards

SCHOLARSHIPS AND PRIZES

2025–2026 **Research Excellence Scholarship for Cross-Disciplinary Training**
University-wide competition to fully fund a continuation of one's studies in a different department – in my case, UCL Philosophy.

2025 **Yale–UCL Scholarship**
Full funding for research stay at Yale University.

2024 **ASLP Essay Prize**
Awarded by the Australasian Society of Legal Philosophy for best paper in legal theory.

2024 **Lex Academic Prize**
Awarded by Lex Academic, SIFA & *Argumenta* for best paper in action theory and ethics.

2024 **NEN Paper Prize (finalist)**
Runner-up for best submission at the Northeast Normativity Workshop essay competition.

2023 **Project Development Grant**
Awarded by Clearer Thinking Foundation for 'Understanding Moral Luck' project.

2023 **Young Scholar Prize (finalist)**
Runner-up for best submission in practical philosophy at the 15th SIFA Conference.

2023, 2025 **Max Planck Fellowship**
Full funding for research stay at the MPI for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law.

2022–2025	Research Excellence Scholarship & Overseas Research Scholarship UCL’s most prestigious funding package ‘awarded only to the most outstanding potential and existing research students from all departments and faculties’.
2022–2026	Hollond-Whittaker Research Studentship (declined) Full funding to study at Trinity College, University of Cambridge.
2022	Poster Prize Best poster at the 3 rd SPP and ESPP Joint Conference.
2021	Orelli Prize Biannually awarded by the Faculty of Law of UZH for an ‘extraordinary thesis’.
2021	William James Prize (finalist) Runner-up for best graduate submission at the 47 th Soc. for Phil. and Psych. Conference.
2019–2020	Clinton Fellowship Awarded by ETH Zurich and Clinton Foundation for ‘Urban Classroom’ project.

COMPETITIVE CONFERENCE FUNDING

2023 (4×)	Neuchâtel Action Conference (Neuchâtel); 27th Oxford Graduate Conference in Philosophy (Oxford); 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (Sydney, ceded); Philosophy and Computer Science Summer School (Bayreuth)
2020	12th Clinton Global Initiative University Conference (Edinburgh)

Talks

† = refereed [20], ‡ = invited [14], ∇ = received comments [5]

PAPER PRESENTATIONS

Sep 2026	‘LLMs, Naked Statistical Evidence, and Legal Proof’ (in German) 34 th Young Forum for Legal Philosophy Conference, University of Zurich †
Sep 2025	‘Intentions, <i>de dicto</i> and <i>de re</i>’ 12 th German Society for Analytic Philosophy Congress, HHU Düsseldorf †
Nov 2025	‘Ordinary Recklessness Wrongdoing’ Work-in-Progress Series, Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law ‡
Feb 2025	Experimental Philosophy Lab, Yale University
May 2025	‘Making Sense of Mistakes of Fact’ Foundations of Criminal Responsibility Workshop, Cambridge Univ. ‡ ∇ ∇
Mar 2025	Cambridge Legal Theory Discussion Group, Cambridge University † ∇
Nov 2024	Edinburgh Criminal Law Discussion Group, Edinburgh University †
Jul 2024	Philosophy Department Colloquium, Univ. of Erlangen-Nuremberg ‡
May 2024	Criminal Law Group Brown Bag Lunch, University of Zurich ‡

Sep 2024	‘The Significance of Philosophy of Action for Criminal Law’ Theorising Criminal Law Workshop, University of Zurich ‡
Jul 2024	‘Causation, Norms, and Cognitive Bias’ Experimental Jurisprudence Workshop, University of Surrey ‡
Feb 2024	‘Untangling the Gordian Knot of Motive’ Edinburgh Criminal Law Discussion Group, Edinburgh University †
Feb 2024	Criminal Jurisprudence and Philosophy Group, Cambridge University †
Nov 2023	Cambridge Legal Theory Discussion Group, Cambridge University † ▽
Sep 2023	Criminal Law Department Meeting, Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security, and Law
Dec 2023	‘The Unity of Motive’ Neuchâtel Action Conference, University of Neuchâtel †
Nov 2023	27 th Oxford Graduate Conference in Philosophy, Oxford University † ▽
Sep 2023	15 th Conference of the Italian Society for Analytic Philosophy, University of Eastern Piedmont † — runner-up for <u>Young Scholar Prize</u>
Jul 2023	97 th Joint Session of the Aristotelian Society and the Mind Association, Open Session, Birkbeck, University of London †
Sep 2022	‘Closeness and Double Effect’ Conference for Young Analytic Philosophy, University of Salzburg †
Jul 2023	‘Causation, Foreseeability, and Norms’ 45 th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Univ. of Sydney †
Jul 2022	3 rd Joint Conference of the Soc. for Philosophy and Psychology and European Soc. for Philosophy and Psychology, Univ. of Milan (poster) † — winner of <u>Poster Prize</u>
Jul 2022	30 th International Association for Philosophy of Law and Social Philosophy World Congress, SW 21, Dimitrie Cantemir Christian Univ. of Bucharest †
Feb 2022	Doctoral Students Day: Perspectives on Philosophy in Switzerland, Univ. of Basel (poster) †
Sep 2022	‘Misascription of Action-Descriptions’ 17 th Conference of the Swiss Psychological Society, Univ. of Zurich †
Jun 2022	UK-IVR 2022 Annual Conference, University of Surrey †
Jun 2020	1 st European Experimental Philosophy Conf., Charles Univ. Prague †
Oct 2021	‘Causation and the Silly Norm Effect’ Georgetown Lab for the Empirical Study of Law and Language, Georgetown University ‡
Oct 2021	Reasons and Decisions Lab, Lake Forest College ‡
Sep 2021	28 th Conference of the European Society for Philosophy and Psychology, University of Leipzig †

Aug 2021	Law, Language, and Philosophy Summer School, Inter-University Centre Dubrovnik
Jun 2021	47 th Annual Meeting of the Society for Philosophy and Psychology, Princeton University † — runner-up for <u>William James Prize</u>
Jun 2021	2 nd European Experimental Philosophy Conf., Charles Univ. Prague †
	‘Action, Intention, and Double Effect’
May 2021	Values and Reasons Research Colloquium, University of Zurich
	‘Anscombe, Davidson, and Criminal Law’
May 2020	Values and Reasons Research Colloquium, University of Zurich
	‘Inculcating Mental States Across Cultures’
Jul 2019	29 th International Association for Philosophy of Law and Social Philosophy World Congress, SW 148, University of Lucerne

COMMENTS

	JP Fassnidge: ‘Criminalisation Theories: A Meta-Normative Inquiry’
Nov 2025	Book Workshop, University of Aberdeen ‡
	David Chandler: ‘Back to the Phineas Gage Effect’
Sep 2025	Philosophy Graduate Conference, University College London ‡
	Lewis Ross: ‘What Does the End of Punishment Mean?’
Jun 2025	The Distinctiveness of the Criminal Standard of Proof, Univ. of Zurich ‡
	Shraddha Chaudhary: ‘The Moral Wrongs of Sexual Exploitation’
May 2025	Criminal Law and Philosophy Conference, University of York
	Anna Peters: ‘The Duty to Criminalise’
Dec 2024	Philosophy, Law, and Politics Graduate Forum, King’s College London ‡
	Manuel Cordes: ‘Criminal Responsibility as Reasons-Responsiveness’
Dec 2024	ECR Workshop, University of Glasgow ‡
	Philipp Hirsch: ‘How Criminal Law Disapproves of Our Reasons for Action’
Nov 2024	Centre for Criminal Law, University College London ‡
	Daniel Miller: ‘Why Culpable Ignorance Requires Awareness’
Sep 2024	Workshop on Wilful Blindness and Mistakes of Fact, Max Planck Institute for the Study of Crime, Security and Law ‡
	Joshua May: ‘Are Rights a Rationalization?’
Jun 2024	Workshop on M. Mahlmann’s <i>Mind and Rights</i> , University of Zurich ‡

GUEST LECTURES

	‘Experimental Jurisprudence’ (in German)
Jul 2026	Introduction to Experimental Philosophy, Heidelberg University ‡

Legal Practice

2019–2022	Legal Consultant Levuro (Tech Start-Up)
Jul–Aug 2019	Law Firm Intern Schwärzler Attorneys at Law
Sep 2018	Court Intern District Court Andelfingen, Canton of Zurich

Summer Schools

Jul 2023	Philosophy and Computer Science University of Bayreuth
Aug 2021	Law, Language, and Philosophy Inter-University Centre Dubrovnik
Jul 2021	Causation and Responsibility University of Berne
Jul 2021	Ancient Philosophy University College London

Volunteer and Outreach

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Sep 2023	‘Understanding Moral Luck’ Clearer Thinking Foundation Project aimed at making the ethical implications of moral luck accessible to the public.
Jun 2022	Career Forum Speaker International School of Schaffhausen (ISSH) Introduced prospects in law and philosophy to ca. 25 high schoolers.
2021	Graduate Student Representative of Switzerland Youth Forum on the Future of the Humanities (EHC 2021) Formulated recommendations in cooperation with the Portuguese National Funding Agency, International Council for Philosophy and Human Sciences, and UNESCO.
2019–2021	‘Urban Classroom’ Clinton Global Initiative University (CGI U) Project aimed at making expert knowledge accessible to the public (led a group of three).
2018–2020	Legal Consultant University of Zurich Student Association (VSUZH) Free legal consultation open to all UZH and ETH students (150+ students assisted).

INTERVIEWS

- May 2024 **‘Ethics of Mass Surveillance’**
Lucerne University of Applied Sciences and Art
Interviewed about legal and moral issues surrounding mass surveillance and AI.
- Mar 2023 **‘Boundaries between Law and Philosophy’**
The Philosopher’s Nest Podcast
Interviewed about quandaries at the intersection of law and philosophy.

WORKSHOPS

- Oct 2025 **‘The Promises and Perils of AI in Education’**
International School of Schaffhausen (ISSH)
Gave a workshop to the teaching staff on the interplay between AI and good education.

Academic Citizenship and Supervision

† = Dpt. of Psychology

UNIVERSITY COLLEGE LONDON

- Writing Tutor**
- 2024–2025 20× LLB
2023–2024 21× LLB
- Academic Mentor**
- 2023–2024 10× LLM
- UCL Journal of Law and Jurisprudence**
- 2022–2023 Editor
- Research Essay Supervisor**
- Terms 1–2 ‘22 1× graduate (relation of law and liberty)

UNIVERSITY OF ZURICH

- Thesis Co-Supervisor**
- Fall ‘25 1× graduate (mental illness and criminal responsibility) †
Spring ‘24 3× graduate (biases in legal and moral decision-making) †
Spring ‘23 1× graduate (epistemology of criminal procedure law)
Spring ‘22 2× undergraduate (constitutional guarantees of freedom and equality)
2× graduate (sexual violence and consent in criminal law)
- Fall ‘21 3× undergraduate (moral foundations of criminal law in relation to evolutionary biology, neuroscience, and behavioural economics)
- Marking Assistant**
- Spring ‘22 First-year course ‘Legal Theory’ (3 ECTS)

Spring '21 First-year course 'Legal History' (6 ECTS) and second-year course 'Private Law II' (18 ECTS)

Fall '20 First-year course 'Public Law I' (15 ECTS)

REFEREE

Full articles Bloomsbury Press, *Cognitive Science* (2×), Cognitive Science Society (3×), *European Journal of Philosophy*, Northeast Normativity Workshop (2×), *Philosophical Quarterly*, *Studi di estetica*, *UCL Journal of Law and Jurisprudence*

Abstracts AI Ethics and HCI Conference, GAP Conference